about 809 ventilators had been supplied to the state, out of which a significant amount remained uninstalled.[51] After repeated reports of the state not even installing them, the secretary of the MoHFW wrote a letter to the chief secretary of Punjab asking the state to speed up installations, urging him that 'non-commissioning of the ventilators defeats the purpose of their use in the fight against Covid'. Finally, much after the second wave had reared its head, the Punjab government woke up to the need for ventilators and called the manufacturers to install them. When the team from the manufacturing company reached Punjab, they noticed that the hospitals where the ventilators needed to be installed hadn't even arranged for appropriate connectors (a specific part required to connect the hospitals' piped oxygen system). In addition to the lack of initiatives taken, the dispatched team also found that the oxygen pressure in hospitals was not adequate to operate several installed ventilators, which could easily lead to malfunction of the machines and eventually human casualties.[52]

When a second team of manufacturers from Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) reached Punjab to investigate the causes for malfunctioning units produced by them, they found stunning revelations. According to M.V. Gowtham, Chief Managing Director of BEL, it was non-utilization of ventilators which was making them unfit for use. He further explained the Punjab government's irresponsibility,

> There are flow sensors connected with the patient's ICU and then there are oxygen sensors. When our team when to Faridkot, we saw that consumables were not replaced. It is mandatory to change the flow sensor each time a new patient comes to the ICU. Second, some ventilators were not calibrated along the latitude-longitude of Faridkot during installation. Whenever a ventilator changes location, oxygen pressure must be changed according to that location. Third, oxygen sensors have a shelf life. If you use it with a dozen patients with 100% oxygen, it will deteriorate. It will not work. Oxygen sensors must be changed, which did not happen in Faridkot.[53]

Even more shocking was the revelation that the Centre supplied ventilators based on demand raised from states. After the first wave of COVID-19 ebbed in September 2020, and the first set of ventilators were dispatched, most states didn't even bother to order more quantities to prepare for future